

VIJAYANAND PUPPALA

Quality Engineering Manager — Test Strategy, Automation Leadership & AI-Driven QE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Quality Engineering Manager with 14+ years of experience in software quality assurance across enterprise, cloud, embedded, firmware, hardware, and SaaS applications.
- Leads Quality Engineering teams and end-to-end testing activities for enterprise products, including Hitachi Vantara's Pentaho Platform, Oracle Fusion HCM Cloud, and physical security solutions.
- Owns test strategy, planning, release certification, and status reporting — driving the manual-to-automation roadmap for API and scripted test suites across platform components.
- Hands-on experience building and enhancing test automation using Selenium WebDriver (Java & C#), TestNG, REST Assured, and Postman, with a focus on coverage and reduced manual effort.
- Directs and mentors QA engineers; manages defect queues daily and drives root-cause analysis and resolution with cross-functional development teams.
- GenAI & agentic engineering: pioneered a spec-driven AI-DLC methodology and an agentic SDET workbench, evaluating and adopting AI-based testing approaches (models spanning Claude, GPT-4, GLM, DeepSeek, local Ollama) to expedite delivery, improve quality, and reduce cost.
- Proficient with AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, Oracle, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, HP ALM, Jira, Confluence, and Jenkins.
- Collaborative leader with strong communication, stakeholder management, and problem-solving skills, committed to delivering reliable, customer-focused software solutions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Quality Engineering Leadership	Test Strategy, Planning & Execution	Automation & Tooling
Team Management & Mentoring	Release Certification & Sign-off	Selenium · TestNG · REST Assured · Postman
Defect Management & RCA	AI-Based Testing Adoption	Jenkins · Jira · Confluence · HP ALM
Stakeholder & Status Reporting	AI-DLC · Agentic Engineering	AWS · Azure · Docker · Kubernetes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Quality Engineering Manager M3 | Hitachi Vantara India Pvt. Ltd. (Pentaho) — Hyderabad Jan 2022 – Present

- Lead Quality Engineering across the Pentaho Platform, including Data Catalog, Data Optimizer, and Data Management components, across multiple release cycles.
- Own test strategy and planning; drive the manual-to-automation roadmap for API and scripted test suites across platform components, overseeing REST API test automation and regression coverage.
- Drive monthly certification activities end-to-end, including release sign-off and status reporting to stakeholders.
- Direct and mentor QA engineers; delegate and review test case and automation script work; identify test coverage gaps and track remediation to closure.
- Monitor the defect queue daily; coordinate with development and cross-functional teams on root-cause analysis, resolution, and closure.
- Evaluate and adopt emerging automation and AI-based testing approaches — including a spec-driven AI-DLC methodology and an agentic SDET workbench — to expedite delivery and reduce cost, now adopted as a team standard.
- Validate containerized deployment of platform components on Docker and Kubernetes, including environment setup for test execution.
- Represent QA in release/status calls, providing visibility into test execution health, pass/fail trends, and risk areas.

Principal Quality Assurance Engineer | Oracle India Pvt. Ltd. — Hyderabad Jun 2018 – Jan 2022

- Designed, developed, and maintained scalable automation frameworks for UI, API, integration, regression, and end-to-end testing.

- Verified quarterly Oracle Cloud updates and assessed regression impacts across releases.
- Ensured integrations with ERP, Identity Management, Payroll, and reporting platforms met quality expectations.
- Validated security roles, workflows, approvals, and compliance requirements across the platform.

Senior Engineer | United Technologies Corporation (Lenel) — Hyderabad *Jul 2012 – Jun 2018*

- Analyzed requirements and functional specifications, preparing test scenarios for access-control and video-integration systems.
- Designed and executed manual and BPT test cases in HP Quality Center; logged and verified defects.
- Performed functionality, regression, firmware, and performance testing across integrated hardware/software systems.

EDUCATION

- Master of Technology, Electrical & Electronics Engineering — VNR Vignana Jyothi Institute of Engineering & Technology (JNTU, 2012) — 77.93%, First Class with Distinction

ACHIEVEMENTS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Platinum and Gold Awards for successful implementation of the Pentaho Platform across multiple clients — President, Pentaho (Hitachi Vantara)
- Certificate & Multiple Titan Awards for extraordinary performance — Director, UTC
- Certificate & Stallion Award for extraordinary performance — Director, UTC
- Customer Focus Award for exemplary contribution on Oracle Fusion HCM Cloud